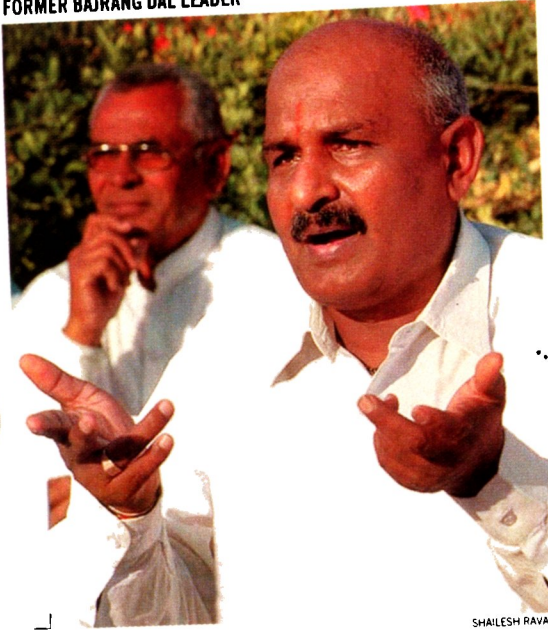


BABU BAJRANGI

FORMER BAJRANG DAL LEADER



SHAILESH RAVAL

The FIR says that I ripped open the womb of a pregnant Muslim woman and flung the baby away. After killing the Muslims we felt like Maharana Pratap.

Bajrangji, 48, is one of the 64 accused in the Naroda Patiya riots case in Ahmedabad, in which 89 Muslims were killed by a mob on February 28, 2002. Bajrangji, whose actual surname is Patel, got the nickname following his association with the Bajrang Dal. A Kutchi Patel, he left the VHP recently following his differences with the party leadership

over his intervention in inter-caste marriages and then joined the Shiv Sena. He has had police cases against him in the past.

In the *Tehelka* sting, Bajrangji can be seen narrating the gory details of how he ripped open the womb of a pregnant woman and went on a killing spree. He says, "It has been written in my FIR that I ripped open the womb of a pregnant Muslim woman and flung the baby away with the sword. After killing Muslims we felt like Maharana Pratap. After killing them, I called up the home minister (Gordhan Zadaphiya) and also Jaideep Patel (a senior VHP leader). I told the home minister we have killed so many people, please take care of us. He told me to flee the spot, hide somewhere and save myself."

"We were doing a running commentary for the home minister from the field when the riots were on. Modi also helped me in many ways. He asked me to flee and kept me in hiding in Abu, and, finally, when I was arrested he ensured the transfers of three lower court judges to facilitate bail for me. No one can do what Modi did. He came to Naroda Patiya, saw our enthusiasm and thanked us." After the exposé, Bajrangji has gone underground and has been avoiding the press.

Legal status: After the Naroda Patiya massacre, he evaded arrest for over four months and was finally caught in June 2002. He was in jail for six months before he was given bail.

HARESH BHATT

NATIONAL BAJRANG DAL VICE-PRESIDENT

Bhatt, 53, was the national Bajrang Dal vice-president when the riots broke out. In the *Tehelka* sting he says, "Modi was very favourable to us."

SHAILESH RAVAL



Modi gave us three days (after the Godhra carnage) to do whatever we wanted in order to settle scores. After three days, when he told us to stop, we stopped.

Hamare main apas ka milap tha (We were hand in glove). Modi gave us three days (after the Godhra carnage) to do whatever we wanted in order to settle scores. After three days, when he told us to stop we stopped. I made bombs using diesel and pipes which were used on the Indo-Pak border (the border of Hindu and Muslim localities in Ahmedabad). We even got swords and other weapons from Punjab. Even rocket launchers were made in my cracker-manufacturing unit at Ahmedabad and were used in the riots."

"I also participated in a meeting with Modi called soon after the Godhra carnage to chalk out a strategy." The very fact that these statements are on camera and were made by none other than Modi's own BJP MLA, that too representing an important seat like Godhra, makes things difficult for the chief minister. Bhatt also mentions being part of a meeting with Modi soon after the Godhra carnage but that is not supported by the records available. Ever since the revelations, Bhatt has gone underground and stayed out of sight.

Legal status: No case was filed against Bhatt in connection with the Gujarat riots. He has, however, been avoiding the media.